

OPERATION MOONSHOT CAFE



A launch brief for Dublin's first late-night coffee bar designed for builders, dreamers, and people who say *one more tiny change* at 11:47 p.m.

FICTIONAL PROJECT BRIEF / PREPARED 03 SEPTEMBER 2026

THE MISSION

Open a 40-seat cafe in Smithfield by **15 March 2027**, earn a reputation as Dublin's friendliest after-hours creative space, and reach break-even within six months. The concept pairs excellent coffee with bookable focus pods, silent sprints, and a weekly demo night called **Ship It Friday**.

1,200

founding-member signups before opening

EUR 18

target average evening spend

4.8 / 5

guest rating target by month three

THE ONE DECISION

Go / no-go checkpoint: 20 December 2026

Proceed only if the lease is signed, fit-out quotes remain below EUR 165,000, and at least 300 founding members have placed a refundable EUR 10 deposit.

WHY NOW

Hybrid workers want a third place after offices and libraries close.

FLIGHT PLAN

From keys to coffee

Four phases, one opening date, and no heroic all-nighters required.

01

PROVE

Sep-Oct 2026

Run two pop-ups, interview 40 guests, validate a EUR 6 evening coffee-and-snack bundle.

02

BUILD

Nov-Dec 2026

Sign lease, lock the floor plan, select equipment, and hit the 300-deposit checkpoint.

03

REHEARSE

Jan-Feb 2027

Hire 8 people, test service scripts, host three invite-only nights, fix the awkward bits.

04

LAUNCH

15 Mar 2027

Open at 07:00, celebrate at 19:00, and keep the espresso machine away from confetti.

THE PEOPLE WE ARE BUILDING FOR

MAYA

FREELANCE DESIGNER

Needs calm lighting, reliable Wi-Fi, and a place where one cappuccino can become two productive hours.

EOIN

INDIE HACKER

Wants late opening, power everywhere, and friendly accountability without a networking ambush.

NIA

POSTGRAD RESEARCHER

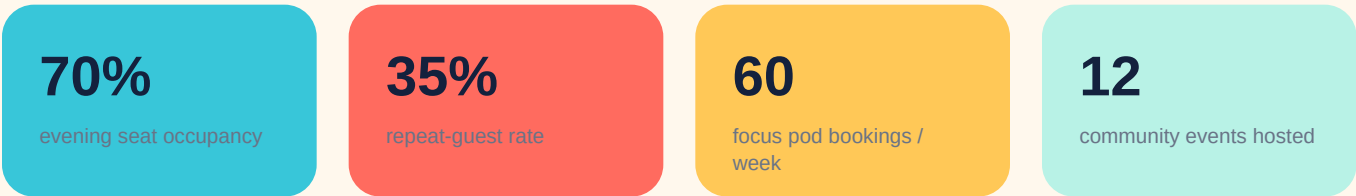
Values quiet zones, affordable refills, and staff who will gently guard the no-call tables.

MISSION CONTROL

What success looks like

A short scorecard, the risks that matter, and one delightfully unnecessary stretch goal.

FIRST 90 DAYS



TOP RISKS AND RESPONSES

Fit-out runs late	HIGH	Order long-lead equipment by 5 January; hold a two-week schedule buffer.
Evenings feel too quiet	MEDIUM	Program three recurring events and partner with two local maker groups.
Guests camp all day	MEDIUM	Use time-boxed focus pods and a friendly peak-time minimum spend.
Team burns out	HIGH	Cap closing shifts, publish rotas 21 days ahead, and protect two no-event nights.

STRETCH GOAL / CODE NAME: CRULLER ORBIT

If founding-member deposits reach **500 before 1 February**, launch a limited-edition Apollo Cruller and send the first one to the International Space Station. Legal says the second half may require a slightly larger budget.

BOTTOM LINE

Validate demand before signing. Protect the opening date. Measure repeat visits, not just launch-week buzz.